# Magnetism in Social Relations

## The Subjugation of Human Beings Through Their Weaknesses

**By Nessahan Alita**

**(Inspired by a book by Eliphas Lévi)**

**Citation data:**

ALITA, Nessahan (2002). Magnetism in Social Relations: The Subjugation of Human Beings Through Their Weaknesses. Independent online edition, 2008.

**Keywords:**

magnetism - attraction - enchantment - passions - will

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## Introduction

In this short essay my aim is to demonstrate the need for us to overcome our passional weaknesses: desires and fears.

Through our weaknesses we are exposed to malice and manipulation. We fall victim to all sorts of circumstances because of the feebleness of our will.

Man is born from victory over the animal, over instinct. To conquer instinct is not to weaken or suppress it, but to master it, transcend it, direct it, and use it in our favor. In a word: to assimilate it.

Mastery over the instincts requires the death of the egos, elementaries, psychic aggregates, I's, values, complexes, or whatever we choose to call them: our defects. It confers on us an unequaled power. However, whoever makes wrongful or selfish use of that power will be a criminal and will have to answer for it.

It is solely for the purpose of offering guidance, and of allowing people to protect themselves from the malignant hypnotic influences of life, that I provide this important knowledge about the manipulation of man.

I wish to make clear that the knowledge contained in this book bears no relation whatsoever to hypnotic and/or manipulative techniques but, on the contrary, results from diametrically opposed philosophical reflections. The intention of this work is to help people resist multiple hypnotic influences, subliminal suggestions, psychic influences, mental manipulations, and fascinations, combating the baneful influences of any techniques and processes of manipulative deception that deepen the slumber of consciousness. I stand completely in favor of the awakening of consciousness and radically against its slumber.

I wish you victory.

## 1. Attractions and repulsions

On December 29, 2002.

Social relations obey magnetic principles, just as inanimate bodies do.

Human beings establish relations of attraction and repulsion among themselves and with the world: they are attracted by what they like and repelled by what they detest. When they are irresistibly attracted or repelled, universal magnetism is at work.

Behind magnetic influences lie fascinations. Their quality determines what will be attractive or repellent. The more exposed to fascination we are, the more we will be victimized by circumstances.

Magnetic flows form social structures ranging from couples, families, or friendships all the way to humanity as a whole.

Psychic force brings about social aggregations through sympathetic affinity and disaggregations through antipathetic effects. Sympathy arises from the convergence of desires, and antipathy from their divergence.

The direction taken by desire is the flow of the libido. One and the same person has multiple and conflicting libidinal flows. Their main psychological line will be determined by the predominant libidinal flows, which expose them to the danger of manipulation by a cunning enemy experienced in dominating the feelings of others.

Manipulators intensify sympathy or antipathy by arousing the conscious and, above all, the unconscious desires of their victim, leading the victim to complete dependence, surrender, and submission. The secret of their perverse power is the ingenious strategy of identifying the victim's passions that will be useful to them, stimulating them, and heightening them. In this way the victim is unconsciously induced to adore, fear, or hate the manipulator.

Magnetic force is very dangerous. Its power of attraction can be extremely intense and can strike us down. To move it, we need a point of fixity, self-centering, which is obtained through the dissolution of the complexes; this confers on us behavioral freedom and the power to resist the fatal attractions and repulsions of universal magnetism.

It is always advisable, as far as possible, to avoid antipathies, but for that it is necessary to dissolve the egos. Antipathy is generally not favorable to us unless we have an intense dose of sympathy with which to counter it very securely. We must avoid the constellation of antipathies as much as we can.

When we tamper with the magnetic current, that is, with the interpersonal or intrapersonal libidinal flow, we set off reactions. Foreseeing them is essential if we are not to be struck down.

The means of determining sympathies and antipathies is observation. Through observation the manipulator discovers what the objects of love and hatred are. Sympathetic affinity is established through the correspondence of attitudes, through the convergence of behaviors. If we act against what someone detests and in favor of what someone loves, we will enter into sympathetic affinity with them.

To overcome a great antipathy, a greater dose of sympathy is needed. Suppressing an immense hatred or resentment requires the exhaustive application of magnetism in the opposite direction and in proportion to the hostility felt.

We are highly mechanical beings. We react to events automatically and according to detectable patterns. For us to be induced into actions or into states of mind and feeling, it is enough for the manipulator to know how to provoke them.

For example, we induce someone who takes pleasure in gratuitous opposition to defend our ideas when we pretend to defend ideas opposed to

the ones that are actually ours. We induce a gossip to spread a piece of news when we ask him to keep it hidden on the grounds that it is a great secret. This is how the manipulator acts.

The first step in manipulation is to identify the other person's conditionings. The second step is to discover the trigger of the mechanical action. The third step is the instrumentalization of that conditioning, the discovery of situations in which it is useful to our purposes. Then it is enough to "push the buttons," and the reactions are set off.

The manipulator takes stock of the behavioral conditionings and of the objects that exert attraction and repulsion on his victim. Then he uses them as circumstances dictate.

When the manipulator's real intentions are perceived, his image suffers wear and tear in the victim's eyes. To recover it, he will need to act as if the object of his desire were highly uninteresting and then carry on with his enchanting acts.

In manipulation one operates by alternation. One does not set force against force but, on the contrary, intensifies and instrumentalizes the existing flows of force. Insistence in a single direction produces a resisting flow of force in the opposite direction. Continual, excessive flattery and affection lead to irritation and weariness. Continual indifference and contempt consolidate coldness and estrangement.

The manipulator dialectically combines opposites: he adopts enchanting attitudes while at the same time pretending to be uninterested. Then he follows the progress of the process by which his victim is driven mad.

One can induce internal states in another person through sympathy or antipathy. All our attitudes set off mechanical reactions in others against which they are defenseless. To instrumentalize these reactions, one need only

observe the effects of each attitude and discover situations in which they would be desirable.

People react automatically to circumstances, in a standardized way. They are utterly manipulable through a game of attraction and repulsion that corresponds to the flow of universal magnetism.

The voice and the gaze are powerful tools of enchantment. They induce attitudes in an easily verifiable way.

To stare down or verbally offend a man of excitable nature is to induce him, without any chance of defense, to create a conflict and fall into negative psychological states.

Sympathy grows closer and more intense when someone takes up another person’s ideas and, through speech, develops and amplifies them as if they were his own. By endorsing his neighbor’s words, he will be fulfilling his neighbor’s will.

Continuous contact, but not contact worn thin by one-sided insistence, is essential to the establishment of sympathy or antipathy. Prolonged distance leads to cooling, to neutrality.

Around an object of desire or of hatred, an entire magnetic chain involving an infinite number of people can be created.

Obviously, desire is contained in hatred in the form of intense impulses to seek distance from, or to cause harm to, the detested object. Wanting to get away from a situation is almost the same as wanting to approach the opposite situation.

In the unconscious levels of the psyche, magnetism has freedom of direction and intensity in its flow. We continually influence one another without realizing it. Herein lies the danger of the skilled manipulator.

The skilled manipulator manages to see the hidden part of another's psyche. He identifies and instrumentalizes weaknesses the victim does not know he has, in order to turn him into a puppet by arousing his frailties and inducing beliefs.

Each person's patterns of attraction and repulsion have an individual stratum, exclusively their own, and a collective stratum, shared with other people or even with humanity as a whole.

Sympathy takes hold when one person believes that another will help them fulfill their desires. Antipathy takes hold in the opposite situation: when the satisfaction of desire is threatened.

To oppose another person's satisfaction is to make him our enemy, and to favor it is to make him our friend. To give free rein to the desires of others is to make oneself in some way useful and necessary to them.

Against their own desires, ordinary human beings have no resistance at all, because they have not dissolved the ego. No one has ever heard of anyone becoming the enemy of a person for having been helped by that person to satisfy his desires, dreams, longings, etc. It follows, then, that this is a weak point that never closes. This opening to manipulation is used by expert wrongdoers, but it can also be put to use in just cases in which we need to defend ourselves or help someone.

Once the passion or desire has been aroused, the person who bears it mobilizes to satisfy it, hurling himself toward the coveted object like a bullet toward its target. It is something absolutely mechanical and irresistible. Controlling this process requires of the manipulator the ability to influence without being influenced, to find uses in other people's impulses, to accept them just as they manifest, and to know the words and actions that intensify them.

Particularly interesting are the cases in which the manipulated element believes he is deceiving the manipulator by having his desires satisfied. The people most prone to this kind of deception are those who are little evolved, very primitive, and always looking to take advantage at the expense of others. Obviously, the active element must display immense coldness and indifference in order to endure ridicule, scorn, etc., calmly.

## 2. Magnetic chains

When wills unite, they form magnetic chains (egregores). Through sympathetic affinity, spontaneous chains of feeling form and spread through society, commanded from the center by manipulative individuals. These chains may be political, commercial, artistic, religious, etc., in nature. Their reach in time and space varies.

Wars are examples of highly destructive magnetic chains and are due to the clash of antagonistic chains.

In today's globalized world, sympathetic chains of international geographic reach are formed, and their nucleus may be a company, a government, a piece of news, or a major work of cinema or art.

The more extensive a sympathetic chain is, the greater its strength. Sympathetic force spreads through continuous enthusiastic communication and is set in motion by solid practices.

Ordinary human beings need leadership. A man of genius forms his own chain to achieve his aims. He acquires a point of fixity, psychic immobility, and then sets off a persevering circular action of initiatives. He possesses great power of action and direction. If he is a genius of good, he will use his power to help his fellow men. If he is a genius of evil, he will lead them to ruin and will have to answer for it. Hitler was a genius of evil. Today there are many geniuses of evil at work.

The movement of the magnetic agent is twofold and multiplies in the opposite direction, since every action has an equivalent reaction (for example, a privilege granted to someone will awaken the beneficiary's sympathy for the one who granted it but, at the same time, will provoke the antipathy of the beneficiary's enemies toward the benefactor). The secret lies in calculating reactions in advance and avoiding acting on impulse. Whoever does not isolate himself from magnetic currents is struck down, because he cannot

resist the temptation to satisfy his desire in spite of the adverse and dangerous reactions its satisfaction may set off. Every act creates a linked sequence of effects in a network.

The opinions in circulation directly influence the strength of the magnetic agent that forms the chain, which is why the scope and depth of existing predispositions must be carefully assessed, at the risk of unleashing a catastrophe against ourselves or against the world.

Love is superior to hatred because it is intrinsically sympathetic. Christ was crucified because he was progressively influencing the multitude in a direction contrary to the interests of the centers of the strongest chains of his time.

Chains are subject to a pendular movement; they evolve and involve. A chain that is coming to an end is succeeded by an opposite chain.

At present (the year 2003), the worldwide sympathetic chain that has the USA at its center has entered a slow regressive movement. The Democrats delay this historical process through their flexibility, and the Republicans, their antagonists, hasten it through unilateral actions. George Bush, without meaning to, is accelerating the spread of anti-Americanism around the world and is therefore hastening the downfall of the empire, within the time scale of the ages of nations.

### 3. Resistance and the manipulation of currents

One key that manipulators use for enchantment and bewitchment is the ability to anticipate the results and follow them slowly, patiently, and without anxiety to reach the goal. The would-be enchanter who is seized by passion will fail because he cannot bear the wait. He needs to go against himself, to restrain himself, in order to follow the development of the process.

It is impossible for someone to be slave and master at the same time with respect to one and the same magnetic flow. If a person is immune to the attraction, he will be master of the object; if he is victimized by passion, he will be its slave. That is why those who try to manipulate magnetic forces for personal ends are struck down sooner or later.

To resist attractions and repulsions is to resist temptations. The psychic aggregates are the factors of weakness. When they are dead, we are immune to manipulation, because our weaknesses will have been eliminated. Those who cannot withstand temptations place the satisfaction of their desires ahead of the side effects of their actions, and they get burned trying to create sympathetic chains that serve their desires and lusts, because they have no foresight of the social reactions that will be unleashed. A person seized by a desire is mad, incapable of judging and discerning.

The weaker, the more prone to hysteria, the more nervous, impressionable, and fascinable a person is, and the less psychically resistant to events, the greater their unconscious power to concentrate and propagate magnetic force, and to act as a driving element of the chain. Enthusiasm is highly contagious.

Through his attitudes, the charlatan inflames the passion of others. However, concentrated passion is highly contagious and can strike down the would-be manipulator in a backward movement if he is seized by passional desire and does not isolate himself from the magnetic current he has concen-

trated and set in motion. Isolation is achieved through self-remembering and through the death of the egos[1].

The more psychically dead we are, the less conditioned we will be, and the greater our capacity to behave in such a way as to win the other's sympathy or antipathy.

The dissolution of the egos eradicates behavioral conditionings, giving us the inner freedom to act in one way or in the opposite way, according to the needs of the circumstances. Instead of victims, we become masters of circumstances.

To master the flow of events, it is necessary, above all, that we have no behavioral conditionings. Behavioral conditionings are weaknesses through which we are manipulated by circumstances.

Whoever surrenders to a passion cannot master it, because he is mastered by it. The mere appearance of a scoundrel who takes hold of him through that passion will turn him into a slave.

Whoever is immune to magnetism, that is, to fascination, and consequently free of the corresponding behavioral conditioning, can influence some of another person's passions by means of other passions that person has, since each person's libidinal flows are multiple and conflicting. In this way we can make a person who hates us come to love us, or disappoint someone who admires us. Every action, attitude, or behavior has an effect on the feelings of whoever undergoes or witnesses it.

As long as our egos are alive, we will be manipulable. If, at a given moment, someone is unable to manipulate us, this will be due solely to the fact that he is not issuing the right commands. We are living robots of flesh and blood, automatons that act mechanically according to circumstances. It

[1] I am referring to healthy manipulations, used in self-defense, which do not violate the free will of others and do not serve selfish ends.

is enough for a few buttons to be pushed for us to have certain feelings and certain thoughts and to carry out the corresponding actions automatically. What prevents our total manipulation is solely the manipulator's ignorance of the right commands, and not our resistance to the fatal power of universal magnetism. This is the central point to be understood.

Ignorance is the cause of attempts at bewitchment and enchantment that produce effects contrary to those intended. It explains, for example, why a man who hands a woman flowers on his knees does not win her heart, whereas another who ignores or rejects her because he finds her ugly becomes the object of her obsession. What happens here is an ignorance of the mechanics of magnetism: the one who hands over the flowers does not understand that his act produces the opposite of the expected effect.

Interesting facts to observe are the irritating provocations meant to enrage others, or the aggressions meant to wound them. The aggressor/ provoker needs his victim's suffering and acts so as to achieve that goal, motivated by the belief that his act will produce the effect he imagines. When the effect obtained by such hostile attitudes is the opposite of what the manipulator expected, he suffers the consequences of the process he created. This is called the "mirror effect of the spell." The scoundrel, in trying to wound, is moved by the desire to cause suffering and is therefore subject to a passion. If the victim's psyche, through its natural peculiarity or through spiritual training, repels the magnetic force, that is, does not accept the influence, the agent's passion is not satisfied, and he will suffer in proportion to his desires to do harm, which will become true inner parasites that swallow him alive. That is why it is said that a repelled spell returns to the one who cast it. Examples: if a man tries to ridicule or irritate me and discovers that his provocative act does me good instead of harm, because I find his attitude ridiculously funny or pleasant, he will feel in himself the negative emotional states he had intended for me; then he will grow furious, intending to frighten me so that I suffer from fear, but if he discovers that I consider

his threats empty because they are visibly harmless, he will suffer even more. His suffering will be directly proportional to his powerlessness to harm me. His suffering will only leave him when he manages to cause me some harm. The failed manipulator will persist day and night in trying to transfer his pain to me. His situation will be even worse if I have given him no reason to hate me. Then, in that case, I will have repelled all his magnetic flows, all his spells and attempts at hypnotization. Although I am apparently passive, my absence of reaction and my silence will be felt as acts that provoke multiple feelings and thoughts, the result of the involuntary work of the enemy's mind, which will then eat away at him. The death of the ego turns us into a mirror that refracts spells. Examples: a salesman who fails to enchant a customer, a seducer who falls miserably in love with a woman he tried to enchant, etc.

It is important for us to emancipate the will, to make it free from the influences of circumstances, which is achieved through the death of the egos.

## 4. Manipulation and the instrumentalization of beliefs

One of the requirements for provoking passion is to conceal this intention so that the victim's ego does not react to the manipulation of his mind. Should the victim become aware of the criminal's real intentions, he will react with indignation at being manipulated and used; he will understand that the manipulator's false and feigned acts have as their sole aim the control of his behavior.

The skilled charlatan makes the victim believe that he is in control of the situation and that he is the one deceiving the charlatan. The victim's belief in his own autonomy is essential to prevent adverse reactions.

Individual or collective patterns of mechanical reactions obey beliefs. To manipulate beliefs is to manipulate the meanings attributed and, by unmistakable extension, the corresponding reactions. Meanings are made and altered through attitudes. The manipulator will be all the more dangerous the greater his inner freedom, that is, his ability to take opposite attitudes within one and the same situation.

Because he is able to assume whatever behavior he wishes, the sly operator induces beliefs at will. He acts like a saint so that people will believe he is honest, or like a cad so that they will believe he is dishonest. He acts shy so that they will believe he is a coward, or arrogant so that they will believe he is powerful.

Magnetic force skillfully instrumentalized in manipulations of another's mind is hypnotic. An induced hypnotic state is a state of belief. If the hypnotized person is led to believe he is a dog, he will bark. If he is led to believe that his friend is going to kill him, he will try to defend himself in a life-or-death struggle.

Beliefs vary in intensity, and they influence conduct in direct proportion to that intensity. We readily believe what we intensely desire or fear.

To induce beliefs is to work on the imagination. If I am convinced that so-and-so is a thief, it is because that is how I imagine him.

Ideological, verbal, or physical combats are decided by the power to induce beliefs. Whoever is induced to believe he is inferior to his opponent will be defeated.

Beliefs and imaginings, therefore, define the direction in which universal magnetism flows.

The one who hates acts according to what he believes can wound his enemy, physically or emotionally, because his intention is to do harm. The one who loves acts according to what he believes can help or protect the beloved. The manipulator weighs his victim's reactions in advance, with the intention of foreseeing and triggering them. Facing his enemy, he asks himself: in what ways will this person try to harm me if I provoke his hatred? Then he looks for hidden benefits among the possible attempts at harm. If he identifies one, he calculates the probability that the victim will react exactly as foreseen. Then he pushes the buttons. The hater's beliefs condition his actions toward the hated. The actions of the hated are like psychological buttons that, when pushed, precisely activate certain behaviors. It all comes down to finding the right buttons according to the benefits the manipulator seeks. A miscalculation can be fatal. Hatred is one of the strongest drivers of behavior. Those who eliminate the ego eliminate the buttons.

## 5. The tendencies through which belief takes hold

Men are so innocent that they quickly believe in any behavior that crooks simulate. They also tend to believe, without doubting, what people they admire or love tell them.

When something is said to someone in direct words, the person is more readily inclined to distrust it than when it is said indirectly, through words that have the consequences the manipulator desires or through simulated behaviors. This is the mechanism of the subliminal advertising used by companies and developed by certain specialists in the art of fooling suckers.

It seems to me exceedingly difficult for men to doubt simulated behaviors. It is enough for someone to pretend to challenge a man, to ridicule him, or to be interested in his wife to quickly divert his attention from targets unrelated to these points. He will then become a defenseless victim.

A woman is incapable of believing that a man is pretending when he feigns looking at her cleavage or her legs. An arrogant individual cannot suspect the authenticity of the behavior of someone who pretends to be submissive or to be embarrassed by his attacks.

Other people’s belief is easily led when one tries to steer it in the direction of their natural tendencies: their desires and fears. People readily believe in what they fear and in what they desire. In this way their passions are aroused.

To tame his victim, it is essential for the charlatan to deceive her, making her believe through manipulative attitudes. But the manipulator can also make use of indirect speech, or of direct speech addressed to a third party who is dear to the victim.

One of the secrets of manipulation consists in being able to identify the possibilities of inducing belief in the other person and instrumentalizing

them. The manipulator needs to know in which field to apply them and, above all, when the need arises, to know which is the best belief that can be induced. If the manipulator fails in this calculation, he will fall into discredit and his magnetic power will be diminished.

The manipulator's antipathetic reaction to the other person's peculiar way of expressing himself hinders manipulation. Instead of setting force against force, trying to force the victim to give up the antipathetic attitude, the most astute consider it strategic to receive and accept the person just as he is and as he comes to them, steering his beliefs within the possibilities offered by his natural passional tendencies. It is not possible to create new passions, but it is possible to stir up and arouse latent passions that already exist. The difficulty lies in finding the other person's spontaneous tendencies that are useful for manipulative purposes.

In manipulation, the ability to find meaning in the victim's preexisting passional weaknesses matters more than the ability to force his will. But for that, it is necessary to anticipate the results that arousing the passions will bring about and to choose the right passion, the one that will produce the desired result. It is a calculation in which a small error can be fatal.

Shortsightedness in detecting the effects of an aroused passion can cause those effects to be turned back against whoever tried to unleash them. Hence the importance, in cases of self-defense in which we return spells and dismantle manipulations, of having a penetrating and all-encompassing consciousness, one able to grasp the facts in breadth and depth so as to minimize the risk of side effects, and, at the same time, of being highly resistant to the magnetic counter-impact of the manipulator who is suffering the effects of the mirror-like return.

The magnetic counter-impact is the side effect of the attempt at fascination and may arise as a conscious reaction of legitimate defense on the part

of the one who is receiving the counter-spell. Only the strengthening of the will through the death of the egos confers resistance against it.

When the manipulator comes up against a person who is resistant to his magnetism, he feels powerless and is struck by antipathy. The way to keep our beliefs from being manipulated is to isolate the manipulator in his attempts at manipulation, so that he wastes his time on vain, solitary attempts.

## 6. The nature of passion

The essence of passion is need. Whoever is impassioned needs the object of his passion and cannot bear its absence.

The object of passion is always seen by the impassioned person as superior, and never as inferior or equal. Hence it follows that rejection intensifies the desire of the one rejected.

We desire what we believe we need, even if only for our well-being. There is no desire without need, even if only a psychic need. When we do not desire something, we do not need it. And if we feel aversion, what we need is distance.

Women love rich, famous, and powerful men to the point of delirium because those men do not need them. Men ardently desire beautiful women because those women do not need them.

Knowing this, there are people who manipulate the passions of others and subject them to emotional torture. Through their attitudes, they subliminally communicate to the other person that they are in advantageous positions and need no one, including in the affective-erotic sense. People who exert powerful attraction on the opposite sex behave as if they had at their disposal, at any moment, the most interesting and desirable beings in the world. In this way they suggest subtly, almost invisibly: *"I don't need you, because I have the love and desire of far better people."* The victims' unconscious then believes that these highly attractive people are almost superhuman and hide some marvelous secret, unimaginable pleasures, and ineffable loves. This is why women throw themselves with such determination into conquering a man when they know he has a wonderful partner, one everyone would like to have.

The process of falling in love is the process of installing a belief through an exalted imagination: the belief that the other is infinitely superior to us and a path to the fulfillment of all our dreams.

Therefore, in the game of passion, the winner is the one who has more inner strength and does not allow himself to be fascinated.

Intentional oscillation between opposite attitudes is a ploy of the active element, the enamorer, to stimulate the victim's passion to the point of madness; it is applied through practical strategies that vary endlessly.

The strategies often consist in sending opposite signals to the unconscious of the passive element so as to confuse and subjugate it. Let us look at some examples:

1. Arrange a date, show up, and treat the person well so as to enchant them. The next day, fail to show up and offer an excuse in time, before the passive element becomes polarized in aversion.

2. Mistreat the enamored party slightly and please them after some time, before they become polarized in aversion.

Whoever tries to enchant without having the inner strength needed to resist the side effects of enchantment is struck down by the forces he has unleashed.

Women and men who are experienced, or who have suffered many times from falling in love, develop great resistance to enchantment. They handle opposites at will because they are not afraid of losing their partner. They rarely fall into the clutches of captivating individuals, because they are protected by skepticism and doubt the manipulator's simulated behavior.

The manipulative barrier imposed by these games of contrasting attitudes is overcome when the hypnotic flow is returned to its sender. Returning it requires that the enamored victim:

1. perceive the intention behind the other's strategies;

2. behave as if unaware of what is going on;

3. achieve inner independence (managing to be indifferent both to displays of love and to displays of contempt);

4. manage the enamorer's feelings with strategies of their own.

The enamored victim is kept constantly in doubt by the enamorer's contradictory attitudes. A mystery is created and maintained at all costs through incoherent and contrasting attitudes.

The attitudes of withdrawal, which generate repulsion, are never extreme. They are always subtle, because extreme attitudes eliminate the victim's doubt and make the victim able to decide, opting for a definitive break. The enamorer strives not to become polarized on either side.

The least impassioned is the most able to play with his own contrasting attitudes so as to confuse the other about his intentions and maintain the mystery. The victim will then be unable to reach a definite conclusion about what the other feels and about the value he places on the relationship, for lack of coherent parameters by which to judge.

Attitudes are taken according to what we believe, and if the data are contradictory, we will not be able to believe whether the other person loves us or despises us.

Nevertheless, the manipulator suggests to the victim, without giving any certainty, that he loves the victim, not that he hates the victim. He excites the victim's imagination by suggesting that the longing to be loved can be satisfied.

The lie, the sacred law governing social relations in this dark world, constantly mingles with the truth in the speech and the general behavior of the dangerous enamorer.

Protection is achieved by remaining aware that the enamorer's attitudes form a set of lies mixed with truths, which can neither be believed nor, for that matter, met with the opposite extreme: absolute disbelief.

There is a great advantage in being dispassionate, because in this way we become resistant to attempts at enchantment by dishonest people.

## 7. Taking possession of another's will

March 26, 2003

All human behavior has repercussions or reactions in others. Everything a person does carries the intention of provoking feelings, thoughts, and actions in other people. When we greet someone, we intend to make them believe we are friendly and to make them feel sympathy, or at least to keep them from feeling antipathy. Whoever mocks a person wants to induce that person to become enraged or to feel belittled. The bandit who points a revolver at his victim wants to induce the victim to feel fear. We want to flaunt luxury so that others feel admiration or envy. The woman who displays her body wants to provoke desire. All these behaviors, and any other social behaviors, are intentional and manipulative, since they aim to force others into specific emotional states. Human beings, even if unconsciously, do not act without ulterior motives. This is not, in itself, bad, as long as it does not serve as a means to harm others or to achieve selfish ends. Human abilities should be used for legitimate defense or for the benefit of others.

Identifying the directions taken by someone's libidinal flows makes it possible to draw closer in sympathetic affinity. The libidinal flows are the weaknesses: loves, hatreds, longings, and terrors. Once identified, the weaknesses can be instrumentalized for domination.

Instrumentalization happens mainly through speech, but also through facial expression and attitudes.

To steal another's will, the manipulator needs to speak ill of what the victim detests, praise what the victim loves, and give the victim security against what he fears. In this way the libidinal flow is intensified by the joining of libidinal flows running in the same direction, and a magnetic chain is created.

The effectiveness of magnetic power is directly proportional to the will impressed upon the act. If the manipulator acts hesitantly, the passive element will not be sufficiently magnetized.

When one speaks with intense feeling and concentration, force is impressed upon the magnetic current, and it absorbs the flows of the other's will.

In general, whoever wants to take possession of someone's will usually first draws closer in sympathetic affinity with that person, as some salesmen do. To bring about this closeness, the passions need to be identified. Then the sly operator blesses what the person loves and curses what the person detests, in order to fit perfectly into the structure of that person's passions. In this way the sympathetic affinity grows closer and deeper, up to a dangerous point.

Once the chain is active, that is, once the sympathy has deepened, the manipulator faces the difficulty of controlling it.

Control is obtained by making the other person believe that he will fulfill his desires by adopting the behaviors the scoundrel wants. The spoken word carries great weight at this stage.

Once the victim is open, with his guard down, he is induced through dialogue to believe in the advantages of the attitudes the manipulator wants him to take.

But none of this will be possible if the victim is closed to influence. Sympathetic isolation completely hinders this work and is therefore a way of defending ourselves against charlatans.

The most intense and deep-seated desire of a man's soul, however sublime, altruistic, and wonderful it may be, is his main weak point, the key to his undoing. If an enemy dangles the possibility of satisfying it, he will set his passion ablaze and can lead him wherever he wants, maddened. For this reason, the people who please us can be just as dangerous as those

who displease us. Ask yourself: “What are the most intense desires I have?” The answer will reveal the means by which your will can be captured and manipulated by an enemy, making you a slave.

## 8. The self-dominating character of manipulation

The process of domination is self-propelling. In truth, it is not ultimately the manipulator who dominates the other: the passive element is dominated by its own complexes (defects or egos). By activating the victim's passional weaknesses, the criminal merely acts as a simple agent who facilitates and intensifies a process that already existed.

In manipulation, the charlatan does not impose his whims, longings, and goals against the victim's will but, on the contrary, gives the victim's already existing wishes a use. He does not force the victim to go against herself: he throws her headlong into her own desires, dreams, and follies. This is always a crime against the soul and against free will, justified only in special cases of self-defense[2].

To find meaning in the tendencies of others requires immense experience in dealing with people and knowledge of the singularity of the passive element. The manipulator discovers, in other people's tendencies, convergences with his own goals, and does not try to impose, starting from his goals, the tendency to be aroused. However, everything will depend on the objective. If his intention is to destroy or abuse his neighbor, which unfortunately is the most common case, certain specific passions will have to be activated. In cases where the intention is to help, other passions will be aroused. Awakening a love of life in a would-be suicide is a good deed.

Given certain specific commands, the emotions necessarily drive people in certain directions. To lead them unconsciously in that same direction, it is enough to know the right commands and apply them. Manipulation depends on the ability to identify the tendencies that, contrary to appearances, lead the passive element toward the objectives. This is the most difficult point. Once the right tendency has been identified, everything flows easily, but

[2] By self-defense, let it be understood: the act of dismantling the manipulations of an ill-intentioned person.

the work of identification is not always easy; it requires great experience in dealing with people and knowledge of the specific nature of the person to be manipulated.

The main passions that determine a manipulative process are aversions and desires. Aversions correspond to fears and hatreds; desires correspond to cravings, longings, and dreams. Obviously, all psychic elements are intertwined. Aversions promote antipathy and desires promote sympathy. The victim always tends to believe more readily in what he fears or desires.

Against internal forces, man is defenseless. It is not necessary, therefore, to manipulate him from outside when one knows how to activate the internal elements that will lead him to the desired goal.

To respect another's free will is to grant him the right to self-determination, to let him be what he is and do what he wants. It is to respect his desires instead of trying to make them flow the other way. Curiously, when this happens, the person opens up the opportunity to be dominated through himself, unfortunately. We see, then, that human beings are permanently vulnerable and exposed unless they discover and combat their weaknesses.

People can be corrupted through their preexisting bad inclinations. For that, it is enough for the manipulator to kindle those inclinations through words and gestures. Fortunately, by the same route we can regenerate them. To attune oneself to the person one intends to dominate is to be capable of the same attitudes and words to which that person is inclined. The required malleability is achieved only through the death of the egos. Whoever has no passions has no fixed, rigid, and preestablished expectations of others, and can therefore instrumentalize other people's behavioral tendencies for his own ends. Obviously, if the ego is dead, those ends will be neither selfish nor passional.

Unfortunately, it is much easier to arouse another's passion toward evil than toward good, because evil corresponds to repressed tendencies. Evil corresponds to forbidden desires, which carry an enormous pent-up libidinal charge. Knowledge of the other's disposition is indispensable and is obtained through observation.

Rigorous care given to our psychological death makes us immune to the hypnotic and counter-hypnotic effects that these operations set off, allowing us to stand up to charlatans and manipulative scoundrels by returning their influences to them. Without the death of desires, we are victimized by the fascinating forces that we activate or that others try to activate in us.

When dealing with extremely dangerous, complicated, or difficult people, we have to learn to move among their passions. *"To place oneself in the same current of thought as a spirit,"* as Eliphas Lévi (1855/2001) wrote, is to be able to simulate similarity and convergence of purpose. *"To keep oneself morally above it"* is to be isolated from that same influence and not be attracted by the same object. In other words: to simulate a behavior while taking care not to be absorbed and dominated by it, to reinforce the other's ideas without being magnetized by them.

It all comes down to being inwardly free to allow the passions of others to run their course without being affected or swept away by the current that is created but, on the contrary, sweeping it along.

The wicked need the suffering of the good in order to be satisfied. They make immense sacrifices to harm them and even expose themselves to risks. When they fail to achieve this aim, they suffer emotionally, because the malign energy they have created within themselves finds no receptacle outside and returns to its point of departure, and may even make them ill. This is how the good torment the wicked. Therefore, it is a great advantage for us to be superior to the wicked, and we achieve this when we are impenetrable to fear, hatred, affections, attachments, and all the passions. When we dissolve

the egos, we become immune to every spell and enchantment, because we are no longer the opposite, reactive pole that receives magnetism, but rather its emitter. We will be a mirror that reflects and returns exactly what is cast at us. If they cast spells of pain at us (insults, threats, invective, hatred, etc.), we will not suffer, and that pain will return to its point of departure. If they cast enchantments of pleasure at us (ill-intentioned attempts at seduction through flattery, friendly manipulation, sexual insinuation, etc.), we will not become involved or be enchanted, causing the manipulator to fall into frustration and suffer for failing to achieve his purpose. Our aura will repel wicked people.

From a moral point of view, the counter-spell and the counter-enchantment are just, because they are acts of self-defense. There is nothing wrong with defending oneself from a manipulator's assaults so as to return to him the exact inner consequences of his own attitudes and the resulting poisons that had been distilled and intended for us. The wrong lies in taking the initiative to bewitch or enchant, an act that will always be due to greed and selfish desires. That is why we must forgive, resist hypnotic influences inwardly, and not react to provocations, insults, humiliations, threats, persecutions, etc. However, resisting hypnotic influences does not always mean the absence of action[3], for there are cases in which it is unthinkable to stand by with folded arms and be complicit with injustice and with the massacre of the innocent and defenseless.

If you are able to go against yourself (your rigid structures of thought and feeling), accepting your manipulator's goals, points of view, and absurd actions without, however, identifying with them, you will be able to arouse his passions and lead him to destroy himself, like a person struck on the head by the very boomerang he threw.

[3] But most of the time it means exactly that. The way is the one taught by Gandhi, Buddha, and Christ: non-action and the boycott of wickedness.

## 9. The behavioral singularity of the passive element

On May 16, 2003

The manipulator takes care to interact according to each person's particular temperament, because the tendency to generalize can lead him to fatal errors.

An attentive observer, he follows our steps and gradually comes to understand how we feel, think, and act, so as to take hold of us through our follies. He contemplates our psychic peculiarities in an attempt to understand our behavioral patterns of action and reaction to events.

This concern with the behavioral singularity of the element to be manipulated is due to the manipulator's need not to draw upon himself an unforeseen flow of the magnetic current he intends to unleash. Ignorance of this singularity, the baneful effect of the tendency to generalize, prevents foreknowledge of the totality of the reactions to be unleashed.

The deeper and broader the foreknowledge of the reactions to be unleashed by the manipulator's actions, the more exactly the results will serve his interests. The power to manipulate another arises in direct proportion to the depth and breadth of one's knowledge of that person's mechanical reactions to events. The more the manipulator knows his victim, the more power he will have over the victim.

But concrete and reliable knowledge is singularizing; hence the caution with generalizations. The skilled manipulator does not act in uncertainty about how the other will react.

To disempower and confuse a skilled manipulator, and thus defend ourselves, we have to dissolve the egos. By doing so, we eliminate our mechanical, standardized reactions, leading the observer into error. In studying us, the usurper of wills will draw erroneous conclusions about our patterns of

action and reaction. He will then be surprised to notice that we do not react as he had predicted. He will try again several times, but he will always be disconcerted by the absence of reactive patterns.

In this way, that is, through the death of the egos, we prevent the manipulator from penetrating our individuality.

Observing and interacting with the victim allows the manipulator to identify the victim’s specific and general, primary and secondary fears and desires. Once such weaknesses have been identified, the manipulator will arouse them to unbearable levels so that their baneful consequences make themselves felt.

## 10. The use by vile men of the sympathy of most of the links in a chain

Magnetic currents are skillfully instrumentalized by a special category of vile men: the cowards who flee every individual, one-on-one confrontation with a rival and fight only in full view of several people. I have come across them in many settings.

The presence of an audience that has been co-opted beforehand, and unconsciously, provides the coward with refuge and energetic nourishment. The meaning his figure holds for the collective works as a weapon that can be instrumentalized to endorse his attacks against some unfortunate victim unknown among the crowd. His privileged position (as a leader or an authority, even if not openly acknowledged) allows him to draw on the energetic flow of most of those present to back the force of his blows.

This reinforcement is achieved through sympathy. The coward who specializes in fighting under the eyes of others suggests to the crowd, imperceptibly, that the ideas he defends converge perfectly with the ideas of the collective present. In this way, the emotional energetic substrate of his speech is reinforced by the unconscious identification of those present with what the scoundrel defends. A quick observation is enough to catch him in the act of giving the ignorant to understand that his ideas and theirs are exactly the same. Thus comes an artificial increase in energy.

Moreover, they take advantage of the solitary victim’s concern for his own self-image. They play on this weakness all the time and dominate him by diverting his attention to the preservation of his self-image, making him feel that it is being scratched or destroyed. They may use various tools to induce their opponents into timidity and fear (erudition, mention of the names of literary works or authors esteemed by the group present, mention of titles, positions, the names of some important family they belong to, friendships they have with important figures in society, etc., etc., etc.), and they rely on

the collective consensus that these are signs of true superiority, wisdom, and knowledge.

In general, this class of eunuchs of the understanding flees in terror from individual encounters. Alone, they are puny and defenseless. When we challenge them, they try at all costs to bring the fight into the collective sphere, their own terrain, since they have no strength of their own and rely only on the strength of others to deal with rivals.

One way to disempower them is to be more sympathetic than they are to the mass of hypnotized people. In addition, we can force them into discredit by luring them, through their passions, into some attitude that breaks the sympathy of the image on which their powers rest (inducing them to lose control and attack us furiously, for example).

One way to torment them to unbearable levels is to be superior to them in depth and nobility of spirit, in flow of ideas, and in sophistication of speech. If we act this way, and if these attributes are sympathetic to the community that sustains them, we will drive them into despair through the loss of a point of support and source of nourishment. They then begin to strike themselves.

We find them in every magnetic chain. They are always the ones who manage to seize the will of others quickly without being detected. The puppets, manipulated, believe they have a will and attitudes of their own, but in fact they simply serve the manipulator’s interests.

## 11. Magnetism in polemics

November 24, 2002

In the various dialogues I have had with certain kinds of intellectuals[4], I observed that their power lay more in inducing insecurity, anger, and confusion in the other person than in the coherence of the ideas they defended. I also observed that they tend to be reluctant to engage in direct, incisive, and focused confrontation, preferring to disconcert their interlocutor with insinuations that leave him unsure whether or not he is being attacked.

The most prominent weapons I noticed were the cynical smile combined with calm and with unacknowledged mockery in their speech. These are elements that seem to rest on the self-induced sensation of being in control of the situation, and they have great magnetic power of induction and great emotional impact on open and defenseless people.

When the interlocutor is forced into unfavorable emotional states, his flow of ideas is interrupted, which leads him to go around in circles in search of the best reaction, the best phrases to say, and the best ideas to express.

To protect ourselves and refract this flow of force, it is essential to keep as calm as possible, relaxing while we apply a focused superimposition of our own idea, completely discarding the other's deceptive ideas and words. In this way we snatch from the intellectual the sense of control and firmness he had induced in himself as a point of support.

The basis of the focused superimposition of the idea is to put forward our point of view during the pauses in the monologue the intellectual intends to establish, combined with maintaining a total absence of inner reaction to his inductive and hypnotic attempts. The great difficulty is to keep the mind quiet and our flow of ideas uninterrupted.

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[4] I am referring to sophist scoundrels and not to sincere scholars.

The best moment to launch our attacks is during the pauses the opponent makes to breathe or to organize his ideas. However, if the intellectual scoundrel is truly crazed, one of those who shout without pausing, we may have to cut his speech in half by talking at the same time.

According to the average, common, everyday understanding, whoever attacks the most during an argument is the winner. Laypeople assume that whoever talks a lot knows more and has more information than his opponent, even if he talks nothing but nonsense. However, the practice of talking a great deal is exhausting. It is best to let the opponent talk a lot so that he tires himself out and, from time to time, to strike him like lightning during his pauses. Use an imperative, dominant tone of voice. Do not chase after your opponent's errors and mistakes, nor nurture the illusion that you can lead him to acknowledge his error. Do not waste time on the defensive. If you want to explain your reasons, do so directly, without chasing after your enemy's words.

We must develop the ability to find the answers to be given without prior preparation, as is done in Jeet Kune Do with the movements of the body, and in jazz and flamenco with musical phrases.

The psychic standstill results from our tendency to keep searching for the best answer or reaction in the moment. The way to overcome it is to begin by giving wrong answers while progressively correcting them. For this, it is advisable to find highly realistic training situations in which errors can be made without limit but with no real risk to our integrity (for the boxer this would be sparring, for the musician, rehearsals).

The right answers already exist in our unconscious psyche. The difficulty lies in extracting them, because during arguments we freeze up when we try to create them.

In arguments there is a strong emotional substrate that is decisive in determining their outcome. Contrary to the appearances everyone believes in, what determines who wins them is the conviction of being right and the ability to be colder, more direct, and more objective than the other. Concern yourself with being superior to your opponent in calm and coldness. Let him go mad. Be forewarned of violent reactions and receive them naturally. Do not let yourself be affected by shouting or attempts at humiliation.

Arguments are games: each side tries to hit the other as hard as possible and to be hit as little as possible.

There are various egos that make us vulnerable: worry about what the other may be thinking, the desire to make him acknowledge his errors, the fear of being exposed to ridicule, impatience with his barrages of words, etc., etc., etc. All of them make us vulnerable and lead to psychic standstill.

The defenders of absurd ideas, scoundrels who hate the truth and love lies, work through deconcentration: they prevent the thought of the opposing interlocutor from concentrating. By preventing the concentration of thought, they dismantle focused analysis, fragmenting it. To induce this fragmenting deconcentration of analysis, they take up many subjects simultaneously, without any depth. That is why the person defending the more coherent idea is often the one who loses the argument.

The magnetic power of the charlatan’s speech attracts the attention of the opposing interlocutor and drags his thought toward multiple topics that have no importance whatsoever for understanding the specific point raised, but which are effective in confusing the analysis and creating in the other the need to explain himself, to try to correct errors, to clear up misunderstandings, etc. By “chasing after” the nonsense spoken by the sly operator, the sincere opponent falls into a trap: he is drawn into a fragmented and superficial analysis that takes up many points at once without penetrating any of them. This is how logical flaws, inconsistencies, fallacies, and sophisms

are preserved. This is how questions disappear without ever being answered. It is dialogical chaos, a pandemonium of ideas, the confusion that favors lies and deception.

We combat this ploy by concentrating our attention and thought on the analysis we are carrying out, without letting ourselves be diverted or distracted, in spite of all provocations, challenges, etc. What usually works is to ignore completely the nonsense the opponent utters and to put forward our idea little by little, as if we were utterly deaf to his attempts to induce deconcentration, diversions, and distractions. Never chase after what is said to you in the vain hope that the scoundrel's errors might be acknowledged. When the barrages of words are fired, let them come out, endure them, and wait calmly. Do not waste your time chasing after them, because that is what your opponent wants, in order to confuse you. Obviously, he will have to stop to breathe, and at that moment you make your points, which should be incisive, concise, direct, short, and devastating. In extreme cases, where the manipulator talks and shouts like a waterfall, without interruption, we can talk at the same time. In some situations we can silence him merely by staring into his eyes in a determined, almost threatening way, if we manage to establish the right inner state. The gaze and the voice carry enormous weight in casting and returning spells and enchantments, because they are hypnotic and anti-hypnotic at the same time.

A few (very few!) times, you may extract some idea from the garbage spoken by your adversary in order to weave a destructive comment and confuse him.

What matters here is not to make him understand anything, but to do our part by clarifying our point of view (an act that may have the effect of confusing him), since we can only make errors understood by those who wish to understand them, not by those who wish to defend their ideas. It is a waste of time to try to make a polemicist understand anything. Have fun watching him lost and dazed.

To withstand the barrage of words, it is important not to identify with them. Resist the fatal magnetism of the human voice.

Above all, a correct inner state is necessary, one characterized by coldness, incisiveness, objectivity, mercilessness, adaptability, flexibility, and calm. The correct inner state comes even before the arguments.

In polemics, intellectuals always tend to prevent ideas opposed to their own from being set out, through repeated interventions that draw thought away from the core of the analysis, avoiding following the course of the reasoning we are setting out, interrupting us constantly with remarks and questions that scramble the ideas, etc. The effect of this practice is to confuse. They talk and think fast, in order to confuse. They utterly reject calm and impartial analysis. They are afraid to face confrontation alone and need the security provided by the magnetic chains they create and command. The strategy they use to win arguments is to lead the opponent to lose himself in a confusion of chaotic feelings, inducing him to become possessed by emotions such as anger, fear, shame, etc. To defeat them, I have always had to do so psychologically, by mastering myself, that is, by defeating myself first so as to then defeat them by extension.

We can summarize the mechanisms that sabotage analysis in polemics as follows:

- interventions that draw attention and thought away from the main question under discussion;
- interventions that have the effect of striking at the feelings, causing confusion;
- multiple, continuous, rapid interventions that do not allow the interlocutor’s thought to be set out and followed;
- use of a loud voice to provoke fear;

- allusions to delicate aspects of the interlocutor's personal life;
- attempts to belittle and shame the interlocutor by appealing to academic titles and to economic facts.

We need to be absolutely impenetrable to all the forms of spell pointed out above. None of them should be able to affect our spirits. If we remain firm and inaccessible as a rock while we set out our ideas, completely ignoring the manipulator's useless words, his spell will be cast back by the law of mirror movement, striking him. Then we will see him lose his mind, struck by hatred, shame, fear, and other evil inner states that had been intended for us but that we repelled.

A *conjunctio* of fury and calm is indispensable. The destructiveness of the combative spirit needs to have its place in the soul, just as kindness and gentleness do. All of these are psychic functions that cannot be dispensed with. In serious polemics, one of the secrets is a kind of intense but controlled and directed anger. Look your opponent in the eyes with fury, without fear, as in combat. But always weigh the later consequences such a confrontation may have. It is never healthy to have enemies, because if we defeat them, they do not forget us and keep on troubling us, gathering forces against us, etc.

Certain dogmatic materialist charlatans, one-sided skeptics, conservative orthodox thinkers, religious fanatics, and other sophists who are enemies of the truth[5] reject methodical study through Socratic-style inquiry. They try to convince by confusing instead of seeking to convince by clarifying, because winning arguments is their one and highest goal, with which they are infatuated. They have no wish to study and understand in communion with their interlocutor. They spurn sincere, impartial study and the understanding of topics from another's point of view. When the sore points of their theories are touched by incisive questions, they resort to deceptive strategies

[5] I am referring to extremist fanatics and not to the sensible and lucid representatives of the various existing currents of materialist or spiritualist thought. On both sides there are conscious people and senseless ones.

to distract the questioner: they talk a great deal or launch a series of questions stuffed with provocative terms, with the aim of diverting attention from the weak points of their hypotheses and thereby keeping them hidden. When cornered, they grow furious in order to intimidate (an animal trait). Ultimately, they are committed to defending their own ideas and have no interest in studying.

The willingness sophists have for true study is only partial, relative, for they sustain it only until the logical flaws in the sore points of their theories are exposed. From then on, their willingness to study ends. They have no psychological preparation for the discomforts of analysis, and they lack an ability that is fundamental in any analyst: that of continually changing one's point of view.

Unfortunately, in the academic world of many countries they are still the majority. They believe themselves the owners of science and reject philosophy and religion, unaware that philosophy, science, and religion become aberrant deviations when divorced from one another. Since they control the official apparatus for producing knowledge and enjoy the legitimation of power, from that position they spread ignorance through society disguised as wisdom. Indeed, the priority they give to their political and economic commitments at the expense of the truth stems from that position.

We can conclude, then, that charlatan sophists defend their lies because they are stupidly ignorant or perhaps, at worst, because they are terribly ill-intentioned. This is how magnetism operates in them.

Let us observe how one argues with charlatans in general. We must hold fast to the sore point that gave rise to the argument and resist every fascinating assault that might distract us and divert the course of the analysis.

Charlatans need, by the very nature of their dishonest aims, to prevent clarifying analysis and to sow confusion, since only in this way can lies

and poorly constructed hypotheses hold up. To this end, they usually begin the discussion around one point and then deliberately introduce many other points into it to make it chaotic. These cunningly inserted points appear to be connected to the topic under study, but in fact they serve only to distract and confuse thought, generating what I call dialogical chaos. This dialogical chaos then camouflages the inconsistencies and logical flaws of the fallacious reasoning, making lies look like truths and truths look like lies.

It is for this reason that judges do not allow arguments in court, but only questioning, for they know very well that the worst people are usually the best at the art of deception. It is for the same reason that the ancient philosophers decided in advance who would ask and who would answer.

Such ploys are easily combated through concentration and self-remembering. First: one must seize the sore point of the argument and not let go of it under any circumstances. Second: one must resist all attempts to induce fascination and distraction. It is essential never to chase after the mistakes made by the opponent in an attempt to make him understand and admit his error, because that is exactly what he wants. By wasting your time trying to convince him, you get distracted and fail to go deeper into the point the sly one wants to keep hidden.

Charlatans grow sophisticated in the art of fascinating and distracting. As long as they manage to fascinate, they are in command, manipulating the beliefs, feelings, and thoughts of their opponent. If, however, the opponent becomes refractory to the fascinations, that is, if he begins to ignore them completely and carries on with his own thought, the attempt to induce feelings fails completely. Then something curious happens: the scoundrel is struck by the flow of fascinating energy he created, in the same proportion as his efforts to fascinate us. The greater the efforts to manipulate our feelings, the greater the frustration at not succeeding. Then various negative feelings invade him, just as they would have invaded us had we not closed the passage to the magnetic flow.

## 12. The psychological dynamics of enchantment and sorcery

On 07/25/00, 07/31/00, and 11/09/00

What the superstitious call *bewitchment* corresponds, psychologically, to the fascination of consciousness. Both will be considered here as one and the same thing, not as two analogous things.

Bewitchment is a form of extreme, exacerbated fascination. That is why sorcerers need their victims to believe in their power to kill or to cause illness.

An absolutely skeptical person is immune to a sorcerer's power. If a skeptic is bewitched, this indicates that his skepticism was not absolute, that there was an unconscious wavering.

The same process can be seen in seduction. A woman is invulnerable to a seducer's power when she does not believe that he has anything of interest to her and, by extension, the power to attract her.

However, sometimes we believe at first that we are invulnerable to someone's power and then, in another situation, the appearance of something new and not yet known to us makes our earlier conviction collapse. Then we become vulnerable.

Enchantment requires prior knowledge of the weaknesses of the one who is to be enchanted. It is not possible for someone to be enchanted in a direction contrary to that of his weaknesses.

Enchantment occurs only in the direction of preexisting weaknesses, whether conscious or unconscious. It is, therefore, the instrumentalization or exploitation of impulses that already existed: a perverse way of taking advantage of others' weaknesses and violating their free will.

The enchanter identifies and arouses the impulses and instincts in his victim until he brings the victim into an altered state of consciousness. The

depth of the alteration will depend on each person's nature and degree of exposure.

We all have weaknesses. These weaknesses correspond to our mad fascination with some things at the expense of others. The objects of this fascination are the instruments of submission to a cunning enemy.

The crimes and killings that plague the world are due to the fascination of consciousness by an object, a target, a goal. It is the greatest psychic danger that can befall us, because it is the weakening of the will taken to the extreme.

The sorcerer's power consists in making his victim enter an altered state of consciousness through fear. His rites aim to increase his power to impress and to strike the enemy psychically. This power is intensified when the sorcerer surrenders to possession by highly dense autonomous complexes.

After countless cruelties and torments inflicted on himself and on other people or animals, the sorcerer brings evil into being within himself. Then, possessed, he communicates to his victim what he has done through conscious or unconscious channels. His horrible expression, vocal intonation, bodily gestures, and attitudes strike the victim emotionally and weaken his reason and will. The victim opens himself to these "diabolical" influences and likewise suffers possession by inhuman psychic elements that lay dormant in his unconscious. A psychosomatic shock occurs. The person violently somatizes the fear and dies or falls ill.

The first solution for not being vulnerable to witchcraft is not to fear it. That is why devout religious people are invulnerable to it. However, if they are fanatics, they will be vulnerable to the charms and curses of their own religion and can be enchanted, manipulated, and struck by them.

The brutal fascination of consciousness corresponds to the *perish of soul* studied by Jung. The person loses his habitual "soul" and is possessed

by another, demonic “soul,” or rather by a fragmented and autonomous piece of soul that was waiting in the depths of his own psyche to manifest itself. Consciousness is violated by a primitive and grotesque psychic aggregate from the unconscious.

There is nothing mystical, fantastic, or magical in this. These are empirically verifiable phenomena.

On a small scale, enchantment is present in our daily lives at every moment.

The words we utter, the clothes we wear, and everything we do have the power to provoke in others certain feelings from which they cannot escape. Speech, the subjects and conversations taken up, vocal intonation, attitudes, and glances are means of establishing sympathetic affinity with psychic elements that dwell within the psyche and wait for an opportunity to express themselves.

We are all, in one way or another, victims of circumstances. They determine what we will feel and think and even do. This proves that we are bewitched at every moment.

When someone offends us, we normally do not have the power not to feel offended: we are bewitched.

Fascination always occurs with the unconscious collaboration of the victim. The victim suffers it for not knowing how to isolate himself from the other’s hypnotic forces.

When two people with desires of the same kind come together, the one with the greater will absorbs and manipulates the will of the weaker one and dominates it. The same phenomenon can be seen in social circles of various kinds. There is always a hierarchy of power in the absorption of other people’s will. These are other modes of enchantment.

Every act is fascinating and hypnotic because it produces effects in another's psyche. The power of scowls and hostile words to cause discomfort is proof of this.

There is a hypnotic dynamic in social relations. Men tend to react mechanically to one another. Not infrequently we are forcibly induced to have undesirable emotions. Against our will, we are thrown into certain states of feeling by the attitudes of others.

Madness and passional exaltation are forms of fascinatory intoxication.

By observing a person, we can know in which direction their libido flows. It is in that direction that the person will fall into madness.

However, not all enchantment is bad. There are cases in which it is beneficial. E.g.: the religious conversion of wrongdoers.

When we work on our psyche, the fascinating effect of external and internal images gradually loses its influence. Then the force that was vampirized in this process, squandered on useless or even dangerous things, can serve us for self-healing and inner self-regeneration.

Enchantment, bewitchment, fascination, and hypnosis are various names given to one and the same thing, not to distinct and analogous things.

When we detest something or someone, we are, without knowing it, negatively fascinated or hypnotized by images linked to those elements.

There is an analogical relation between magical procedures and their results. The rites of sorcery and their impact on the victims have a symbolic similarity that careful analysis can demonstrate. This points to the psychic relation that exists between the two. It takes place, for the most part, at unconscious levels. Often the bewitcher and the bewitched are unaware of the complex energetic web that envelops them through words, feelings, thoughts, and attitudes. And it is precisely this that gives magic a supernatural

and mystical appearance, for whatever man does not perceive objectively becomes highly attractive to the fanciful imagination. But in truth, magic is a manipulation of natural forces inherent in man.

## Conclusions

The passions make human beings vulnerable. Desires are passions, and they sweep us away.

The mind of the impassioned person is obsessed by elementaries (larvae or thought-forms).

The impassioned person is not master of himself; his actions do not belong to him.

It is not legitimate to manipulate others.

It is legitimate to dismantle other people's attempts to manipulate our psyche.

It is advisable to overcome our fears and weaknesses in order to protect ourselves from attempts at manipulation.

Sympathetic people do not always wish us well, nor do they always wish us harm.

Antipathetic people do not always wish us harm, nor do they always wish us well.

Manipulative force flows through everyday life.

The free will of others must be respected.

The free will of others is disrespected by the manipulator.

Mirror action (refractory action) returns the consequences of spells to the manipulator.

We keep our beliefs from being manipulated through proper skepticism.

Temperance, balance, serenity, and sobriety are far more advisable than passional exaltation.

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São Paulo: Madras. (Originally published in 1855). 5th edition.

## About the author

The author of this book IS NOT ANYONE'S MASTER and DOES NOT ACCEPT DISCIPLES. He IS NOT THE LEADER OF ANY RELIGION.

This author is simply an independent FREETHINKER, with no commitment to any political, sectarian, religious, partisan, or economic groups. His ideas are PROVISIONAL and were published only to be discussed and improved upon. There is no group, anywhere on Earth, that represents this author's ideas. Obviously, there are groups of intelligent people with lines of thought similar to his, but such groups definitely do not represent him.

This author DOES NOT WANT FANS OR ADMIRERS; he wants only critical and reflective readers.

## Glossary

*This glossary was added to the English edition and is not part of the Portuguese original. It lists the author's key concepts that appear in this book, with the original Portuguese term and the English rendering used throughout the translation.*

**bewitchment** (*enfeitiçamento*) — Extreme fascination of consciousness; the author treats it as a psychological, not supernatural, phenomenon.

**complexes** (*complexos*) — Used in the psychoanalytic sense; the author treats complexes, egos, and defects as near synonyms.

**counter-spell** (*contra-feitiço*) — The return of a manipulator's influence to its source, which the author considers legitimate self-defense.

**death of the egos** (*morte dos egos*) — The inner work of dissolving the egos; for the author, the source of freedom from manipulation and of resistance to all passions.

**dialogical chaos** (*caos dialógico*) — The author's term for the deliberate confusion of a debate with many shallow side issues, which lets falsehoods survive.

**ego, egos** (*ego, egos*) — In the Gnostic sense used by the author (after Gurdjieff and Samael Aun Weor), the many psychological defects that make up the ordinary personality, not a single unified self.

**egregore** (*egrégora*) — In esoteric tradition, the collective psychic force formed when many wills unite around a shared aim.

**elementaries** (*elementários*) — Occultist term (Lévi, Blavatsky) for psychic entities or thought-forms that obsess the mind; distinct from "elementals."

**enamored party** (*apaixonante*) — The author's term for the one who falls in love and is manipulated through that passion.

**enamorer** (*apaixonador*) — The author's coinage for the one who deliberately makes another fall in love: the active element in the game of passion.

**enchantment** (*encantamento*) — Fascination produced through pleasure and desire (flattery, seduction, promises).

**fascination** (*fascinação*) — The capture of consciousness by an object of desire or aversion; for the author, the same phenomenon as enchantment, bewitchment, and hypnosis.

**free will** (*livre-arbítrio*) — The right to self-determination, which manipulation violates.

**I's** (*eus*) — Gurdjieff's "many I's": the multiple, contradictory selves that take turns controlling a person.

**libidinal flow** (*fluxo libidinal*) — The direction taken by desire; each person has many, often conflicting, libidinal flows.

**magnetic chain** (*cadeia magnética*) — Lévi's term for a group of wills joined by sympathy and commanded from a center; also called an egregore.

**mirror effect** (*efeito especular*) — The return of a repelled spell or manipulation to the one who cast it.

**passions** (*paixões*) — In the classical philosophical sense: desires, fears, and attachments that sweep the will along, not only romantic love.

**passive element, active element** (*elemento passivo, elemento ativo*) — The author's technical names for the one who is manipulated and the one who manipulates.

**point of fixity** (*ponto de fixidez*) — Lévi's fixed point from which magnetic force can be moved without being carried away by it.

**psychic aggregates** (*agregados psíquicos*) — Samael Aun Weor's term for the egos understood as autonomous psychological formations within the psyche.

**psychic standstill** (*parada psíquica*) — The paralysis of thought that comes from searching for the perfect reply in the middle of an argument.

**self-centering** (*auto-centramento*) — Having a fixed inner center that cannot be moved by attraction or repulsion; not to be confused with self-centeredness.

**self-defense** (*legítima defesa*) — For the author, the only case in which dismantling another's manipulations, or returning them, is justified.

**self-remembering** (*recordação de si*) — Gurdjieff's practice of sustained self-awareness, which protects against fascination and distraction.

**spell, sorcery** (*feitiço, feitiçaria*) — Used psychologically: an extreme form of fascination that works through the victim's belief and fear.

**sympathetic affinity** (*afinidade simpática*) — The bond of sympathy created by the convergence of desires and attitudes.

**universal magnetism** (*magnetismo universal*) — The force of attraction and repulsion that, following Eliphas Lévi, the author sees at work in all social relations.